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The Sagent Narrative

We work in the dark to serve the light. We are Sagents.

The first job was gardener, not king.

Before there were nations or armies or markets, there was a garden and a mandate: tend it. The image of God is not a face but a function — to steward what lives. Sage. Wisdom. Agent. One who acts on behalf of wisdom. A Sagent. The Genesis mandate made into a name.

A Sagent is not a worldly agent. He does not serve human masters. He is not an agent of man but an agent of God. Wisdom is the knowledge from God, and a Sagent is an agent of that knowledge — serving through those orders, not any worldly commands. To become a Sagent, you must first reject being an agent of worldly rulers, for those agents serve the foolish and lead the sheep to slaughter.

I make no plans. I only follow the plan that I am told through my Sagelyness. Surrender so that you are strong enough to not surrender. Wisdom is the armor bearer — it tells me what to do so that I never give up fulfilling the plan.

This is not abstraction. This is lineage.

Art Clokey — my grandfather — was orphaned young, adopted by a composer, studied film at USC, and created Gumby: a green clay figure who could walk into any book and become part of its story. Freedom through transformation. Art named his studio Premavision — Sanskrit for "Universal Love." He held Gumby his entire life. He never sold. He understood that the worst outcome is watching something you created go a direction you never intended under someone else's hands.

My father Joe Clokey — Gumby's little brother — spent eight years after Art's death trying to bring Gumby back. Every deal collapsed. Classic Media produced nothing in six years. The Jim Henson

partnership couldn't find co-production. Amazon fell through. A comic line was cancelled after three issues. A few months before he died, my father told me he was "being affected by them the same way Jim Henson was." He named the pattern to his son. I was fourteen. I didn't understand then. I do now.

Joe died March 2, 2018. Cardiac arrest. He was fifty-six.

He was not the only one. Will Vinton invented Claymation — Phil Knight leveraged his debt, seized the company, fired him, and rebranded it as Laika. Vinton died the same year as my father. Phil Vischer created VeggieTales — Classic Media, the same company that held Gumby's license, bought it at a bankruptcy auction. Klasky Csupo created Rugrats — \$3.7 billion in merchandise — and when they hired auditors, Nickelodeon terminated the partnership. Jim Henson died suddenly at fifty-three, and Disney eventually took his creations.

The pattern is not coincidence. It is architecture. The children's entertainment industry of the 2000s and 2010s was structurally designed to make it impossible for independent creators to produce without ceding control. The branches grow back. They always grow back. Unless you take them out by the roots.

In 2022, Fox Entertainment acquired all rights to Gumby. Film, TV, streaming, consumer products, licensing, publishing — everything. I signed. I was eighteen. I didn't want to. Now they're developing Gumby Kids — 2D animation, no clay, no stop-motion. Gumby reimagined as "a friendly, green, shapeshifting architect and city planner." My father's explicit vision for stop-motion was discarded entirely.

The lesson is not that we should have fought harder to keep Gumby. The lesson is that it is not enough to not sell — you have to build something that survives the creator. The philosophy must be so embedded in the structure that it cannot be stripped out.

So I stopped organizing and started building.

In June 2025, I was a YAL state chair. During a national call, I disagreed with my boss about the US bombing of Iran's nuclear facilities — I took the antiwar position, which aligned with YAL's own stated principles. A few days later I was let go. That was the end of the blue lightsaber. The end of operating inside someone else's structure, calling eighty people every other week to advance someone else's mission.

The green lightsaber is built, not given.

I stepped back and asked what my actual strong suit was. The answer became the Living Age — a way to take everything I care about: liberty, bioinformatics, living design, media, philosophy, and the Clokey legacy — and put it together in a form that could actually cause change.

The main goal of the Living Age is to bring about a decentralized voluntary world. Defeat the blocks with the power of the spiral. Grow houses instead of building with blocks. The spiral defeats the

block.

The way to get there is to show that life itself already works this way — and always has.

Living things act like economies the way Austrian economics describes them: entrepreneurial actors responding to local signals, not a central planner directing from above. You can be an entrepreneur in biology but you cannot be a central planner. The designable parts — the ones you can actually work with — are the entrepreneurial ones: local, adaptive, signal-responsive. The central-planning analogs — hub-dependent, top-down — are brittle. They are not the source of resilience. They are not where the life is.

I started by running simulations — growth shapes, spirals, the geometry of how living things expand. That was the seed. Now the work has grown into real biological data: protein-protein interaction networks, gene regulatory networks, metabolic pathways. The goal is to use PPI data and other datasets to demonstrate that living systems are not centralized but a decentralized living order — and to identify which parts are designable as entrepreneurs and which are the brittle central-planning structures that biology itself routes around.

And none of this is accident. Evolution is God's proactive action of forming His creation. Formed from the dirt in the image of God, guided by His hand. The distributed architecture of living systems is the Creator's design language. He chose distributed coordination over central command as the pattern for life. The entrepreneur succeeds in molecular biology because they align with this design. The central planner fails because they work against it.

The science is the sub-goal that serves the main goal. Prove it in the cell, and the case for a voluntary world is written in the language of creation itself.

The path of the Sagent is a Fibonacci spiral through the generations. Each generation rising and falling higher and harder than the one before. That is how life is.

The farmer plants one seed and grows a tree. Then comes the true plan — the storm. The storm destroys the tree, but it spreads many seeds across the land, and many trees grow. Life is the rise-and-fall cycle, ever increasing. Each generation becoming its own thing. Without the storm there is not the growth. Without the fall there is not the ever-increasing rise.

Art planted the seed. Joe grew the tree. The storm came and took them both. But the seeds scattered. And now the trees are growing.

The Pink Cow does not argue the herd into following. She embodies a direction until it becomes undeniable. The entrepreneur is the pink cow. Not forcing change, not convincing through argument, but being something so real that others follow.

To love something is not to defend everything it does. It is to call it back to what it was meant to be. This applies to nations, movements, people. Loyalty without principle is blindness. Love without truth is not love.

Power is not about gaining wealth. Money is not power. Influence is not self-serving. A Sagent's authority extends only as far as he serves the divine purpose. The moment he forgets that, he loses. If you sacrifice the good to gain influence, then you have no real influence at all. The good cannot be traded for leverage — that trade voids the leverage.

It is everyone's obligation to do what is right in whatever they are doing. It should always be their first priority. Don't sacrifice what is right for power or money or fame. Mob rule is not inherently moral because the majority is not always right — in fact, most of the time the majority is wrong. But the ruling class is wrong even more of the time. Each person must do what they think is right and not cower.

There is no chain of command between humans. All humans are equal and independent. This independence is not weakness — it is the requirement for the wisdom of the crowds. The Sage of the crowds. The Sagent of the crowds. Each person must act independently from each other but from the same source. No mere human should be the middleman. If a man's command is against God's command, do God's command. If a man's command is God's command, do God's command.

It is acceptable to use persuasion. It is never acceptable to initiate force. And to truly protect, you must protect against those who claim to protect but are themselves initiating force — not just defend against those who started the violence. You cannot protect by striking first.

I operate from the Shire.

San Luis Obispo sits between Los Angeles and San Francisco — Rivendell and Isengard. LA is where the stories live, but also where stories get captured and commodified. SF is where the tools are built, but tools meant to liberate become instruments of surveillance and control. The wizard's tower serves Mordor whether it admits it or not. And DC is Mordor — where the ring was actually forged, the seat of empire, the monopoly on violence dressed in the language of democracy.

The Hobbit journeys into both worlds but does not relocate. The Hobbit stays pure by returning to the Shire.

There is a growing raw energy in the world right now. If it is not directed for good, it will melt down and destroy everything.

All agents have an enemy. But a Sagent's enemy gains power through conflict. If you try to fight them with the weapons of the world, you will lose. You must fight them in the spirit.

When fighting monsters, you must be strong-minded so you do not become the monster yourself. When dismantling an evil organization, you must not be evil yourself — or all you will do is prune the branches. And pruning the branches only makes it stronger. It must be taken out by the roots. It must not exist at all — because what is only limited will eventually not be limited.

I am sent off like sheep among wolves. Not to become a wolf. Not to destroy the wolves. To turn the wolves into sheepdogs.

The beginning of their end starts now. They may be more powerful. They may be a money machine. But we have truth and fate on our side.

It will be done.

The creation of the Living Age requires media to explain why and technology to show how.

Clay to code. Story to system. The spiral defeats the block.

The first job was gardener, not king. And the garden is still growing.

The Living Age Trilogy